

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 2
♥ J 10 9
♦ J 8 6 3
♣ 8 7 5 4 2

♠ Q 10 8 5
♥ A Q 7
♦ K Q 9 2
♣ A 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 6 4
♥ K 6 5 2
♦ 10 7
♣ Q J 10 3

♠ A K J 7 3
♥ 8 4 3
♦ A 5 4
♣ K 9

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

6♠ by North

You win the first trick with the ♣A in your hand.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2

There are two obvious possibilities for avoiding the ♥ loser. You could finesse West for the ♥K; this is a 50% chance. The ♦s could split 3-3; this is a 36% chance.

In fact, your chances are better than either of those percentages because you can try the ♦s first, and if they **DON'T** split you can then try the ♥ finesse.

Pull trumps; East shows up with 3 trumps. Play the ♦K, then a small ♦ to dummy's ♦A. On this trick East follows with the ♦10.

Your contract just became a sure thing! Play the ♣K to strip both your hands of ♣s. Lead dummy's last ♦, and when West plays low, finesse the ♦9. If the finesse wins, discard a ♥ from dummy on your good ♦. But if the finesse loses to East's ♦J, he will be endplayed and have to lead a ♥ into your ♥A Q or give you a ruff/sluff with a ♣. And on top of that your fourth ♦ will be good.

In this actual Deal your ♦ finesse worked which gave you 4 ♦ tricks.

But imagine that the ♦J is transposed to the East hand. He wins that ♦ trick but must give you the contract with his return.

You could either use a transfer or you could jump to 3♠. You decide on the transfer and bid 2♥. Partner jumps to 3♠!

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The 3♠ bid is a "Super-accept", showing a maximum 1NT opener, 4 ♠s and a doubleton. In other words, partner's hand has revalued to 18 points. So you bid 6♠ (or you could ask for Aces instead).

The contract would be 6♠ played by South.

North plays 6♠. East leads the ♣Q, West follows with the ♣2.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 2
 ♥ K Q J 9 7 5
 ♦ K Q 3
 ♣ 6

♠ 8 7 3

♥ 6 2

♦ 7 5 4

♣ A K Q 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 5 4

♥ 8 4

♦ J 10 9 6

♣ J 8 2

♠ A K 6

♥ A 10 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ 10 9 7 4

West

North

East

South

2♥

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

your two extra winners will be the ♣5 and ♣3.

So after winning the ♥A, you play a ♣ to dummy's ♣Q and breathe a sigh of relief when both defenders follow suit.

UhOh. Surely you didn't play your ♣4 to dummy's ♣Q???

If you did then just look at the situation now. If the ♣J doesn't fall on the next trick the suit will be blocked. Now go back in time and play the ♣10 to dummy's ♣Q.

That's better. Now under the ♣ A K you can unblock the ♣ 9 7, which will leave you with the ♣4 to slip under dummy's ♣5.

Watch those spot cards. You may have to unblock them to stay in the hand you want to be in.

Partner's jump to 3NT is a lebensohl method.

He is describing a hand with which he would have bid 3NT if there had been no overcall. But he is warning you that he **DOES NOT HAVE** a ♥ stopper!

Since you **DO** have a ♥ stopper you decide to pass and play 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥K.

You hold up your ♥A until the third round.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 3 :: Total = 7

You need two more winners. Barring a 4-0 ♣ split

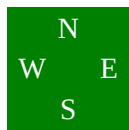
Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6
♥ Q 9 8 5 3 2
♦ Q 10
♣ A J 6 3

♠ A 4 2
♥ A 6
♦ A J 8 4 3
♣ Q 7 2



♠ 10 8 7
♥ 10 4
♦ K 9 7 5
♣ K 10 9 5

♠ K Q J 9 5 3
♥ K J 7
♦ 6 2
♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
3			

You decide to use a transfer so the lead will be into whatever holding partner has in the minor suits. You bid 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

You decide to use a transfer so the lead will be into whatever holding partner has in the minor suits. You bid 2♥ and partner bids 2♠.

You are nowhere near strong enough to be thinking of slam so you bid 4♠.

The contract would be 4♠ played by South.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♣10. West wins the ♣A. They continue ♣s and you ruff the third one in dummy.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total =

Those losers are based on dummy's hand, not yours. You can figure them either way but it is usually easier to determine losers based on the long-trump hand. It's important to remember it in this Deal because the zero losers in ♥s assumes you will ruff a ♥ in your hand.

Pull one round of trumps with dummy's ♠K. Both defenders follow suit. Play the ♥A, then ♥6 to dummy's ♥K. On this trick East follows with the ♥10.

The Plan is still the same, you will ruff the ♥ in your hand, but you better be sure to ruff with your ♠A. Aha! Your precaution pays off when East shows out of ♥s, but of course he cannot over-ruff your ♠A.

A very good Bridge maxim is this: When you are ruffing, ruff with as high a trump as you can afford.

Here, with only 2 trumps left out, you can afford the ♠A.